

Grade 2 Writing Master Manual

CHAPTER 1: FOUNDATIONS

"Writing is the painting of the voice."

— Voltaire

What is "Writing" in Grade 2?

Writing in Grade 2 is the monumental transition from isolated sentences to cohesive, structured thought. The core focus of this course is teaching students how to form complete sentences, expand upon those sentences with rich details, and ultimately assemble them into a proper paragraph.

The Golden Rule of Correction (No Erasing!)

All writing must be done in pencil so that mechanical mistakes can be fixed. However, there is a strict policy during the drafting phase: **Students must not erase their mistakes or the teacher's marks.** Instead, students should cross out the error and write the correction next to or above it.

WHY

Drafting is an evolutionary process. Erasing destroys the record of the student's thought process and the teacher's feedback. By keeping the original mistake visible alongside the correction, students learn to identify their own recurring errors, and teachers can track true progress.

Differentiating Expectations

A- GROUP

Focus: Independence and sentence expansion.

Strategy: These students should be pushed to use vibrant vocabulary and complex sentence structures. They can handle independent planning and can often collaborate in pairs to brainstorm without heavy teacher intervention.

I- GROUP

Focus: Structure and confidence.

Strategy: These students will require significant scaffolding. Provide word banks on the smartboard, rely heavily on the sentence starters in the workbook, and model the brainstorming process meticulously.

CHAPTER 2: THE WRITING PROCESS & FLOW

"You can always edit a bad page. You can't edit a blank page."

—Jodi Picoult

The *myBook* Connection

Every project in the Writing Project Workbook is tied directly to a story in the *myBook*. It is absolutely vital that the teacher reads the target story aloud at the very start of the Writing class, even if the story has not yet been read in the RS block.

WHY

Students cannot write effectively in a vacuum. Hearing the narrative primes their imagination, provides the necessary contextual vocabulary, and sets the thematic stage for the writing project. It gives them a shared foundation to draw ideas from.

The Step-by-Step Flow

1. **Project Introduction:** The teacher introduces the prompt and reads the corresponding *myBook* story aloud to the class.
2. **Modeling the Plan:** The teacher models the planning phase on the smartboard. Show them how to brainstorm using simple drawings, labels, and keywords.
3. **Student Planning:** Students work on their planning pages. They are allowed to borrow ideas from the teacher's model and from each other, but **direct copying is strictly forbidden**.
4. **Planning Check:** The teacher must check and approve the planning pages before any student moves on to drafting.
5. **Drafting Sentences:** Students move to the drafting phase. They must finish the provided sentence starters and then write additional expanded sentences. The teacher models this process on the board.
6. **Drafting Check:** The teacher collects the workbooks, marks the drafts (remember: no erasing!), and returns them.
7. **Paragraph Assembly:** Students write their corrections and then assemble their sentences into a single, cohesive paragraph.

8. **Paragraph Check:** The teacher collects the books to check and mark the final paragraph structure.
9. **Publishing:** Students transfer their fully corrected paragraph to the publishing page and complete a neat, detailed illustration.
10. **The Rubric & Parent Signature:** The teacher fills out the grading rubric on the final page, and the workbook goes home for a mandatory parent signature.

CHAPTER 3: ARCHITECTURE & EXPECTATIONS

"Good writing is clear thinking made visible."

— William Wheeler

The "Shape" of a Paragraph

Second graders do not instinctively know what a paragraph looks like. If left unguided, they will write sentences in a list format, with one sentence per line. They must be explicitly taught the physical architecture of a paragraph.

- **The Title:** Must be centered at the very top of the page.
- **The Indent:** The first line of the paragraph must be indented. Show them how to use "two fingers" to measure the space.
- **The Margins:** Students must write all the way to the right margin (the edge of the paper) before moving down to the next line.
- **The Return:** When moving to the next line, they must start completely at the left margin.

The Neatness Standard

Messy writing is not accepted. If a student's handwriting is illegible, rushed, or careless, it must be redone. The Publishing phase, in particular, should represent their absolute best penmanship.

CHAPTER 4: SCHEDULING & LOGISTICS

"Give me six hours to chop down a tree and I will spend the first four sharpening the axe."

— Abraham Lincoln

Maximizing the 80-Minute Block

Your writing instruction takes place during a dedicated 80-minute block (two back-to-back 40-minute periods). **Do not use this block for prolonged, silent writing.** This time is perfect for active instruction. Use these 80 minutes to read the story aloud, model planning and drafting, facilitate brainstorming, and get students started on independent work.

The Homework Heavy-Lifting

Because classroom time is tight, the bulk of the actual writing execution is done at home. The drafting, paragraph assembly, and specifically the final **Publishing and Illustrating** phases are intended to be completed as homework. This maximizes your in-class time for direct support, grammar integration, and collaborative brainstorming.